

A guide to Self-Publishing for Zim Independent Authors

(Publishing Services for Independent Authors)

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Introduction

This manual explains the four steps in the process of book publishing. A lot of writers in this era have come to realize the advantages of self-publishing their works. Though that is a good move I have noted how unprofessional these authors are doing publishing. I wrote this manual to inform most upcoming and self-publishing authors concerning the five basic steps they need to take in self-publishing their works and how they can do it professionally.

Apart from the wide range of services we provide, Pearl Press Media also provides book publishing services for Independent authors or self-publishers.

An independent author/self-publisher is a person who chooses to publish his/her works on his/her own without going through traditional publishing houses.

Be it a novel—fiction or nonfiction, religious books, poetry, devotional or any other type of a book; Pearl Press Media offers the publishing services that you need throughout the course of your publishing journey.

We also offer consultants and advisory services for self-publishing and aspiring authors. You can book for an appointment on any of the numbers displayed on the title page of this manual.

In book publishing there are five basic steps you should take after you have written your book. The five are outlined in the following chapters:

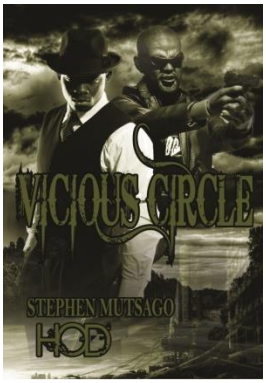
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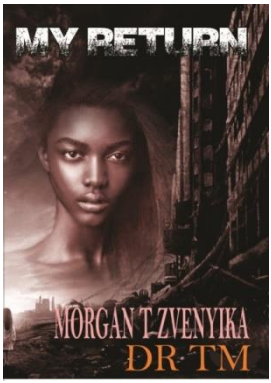
Cover Design

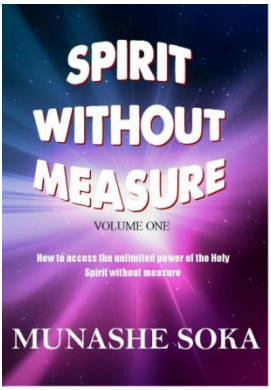
Let's begin with the outside look of the book—the cover.

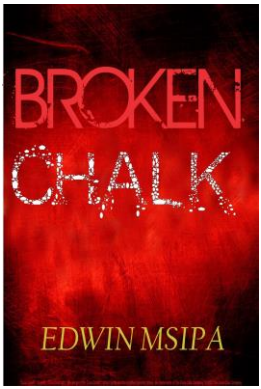
Our graphic designers will design a perfect cover design that suits your topic. Professional cover design is very important since people judge a book by its cover.

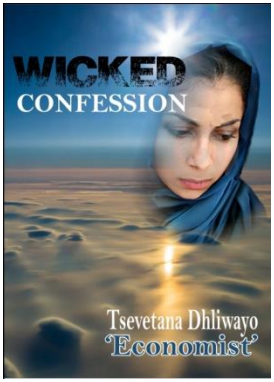
Since there are a lot of books on the market, for you to fight the competition you have to make sure your book cover has been professionally designed. The following are images of some of the cover designs that our designers have done.

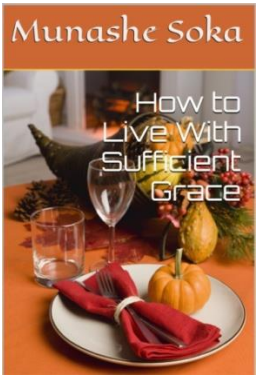












Cover design is an art and if you want a professional cover design you have to let a professional designer do it for you.

One of our designers once said this:

"*A cover design must not TELL the story but it only has to SHOW the story.*"

There is a difference between telling and showing.

Most self-publishers want their covers to TELL the reader everything that is in the story, but it must not be so. Have you ever watched a film with someone who will be telling you what is going to happen next? So when you design a cover you DON'T have to TELL the story.

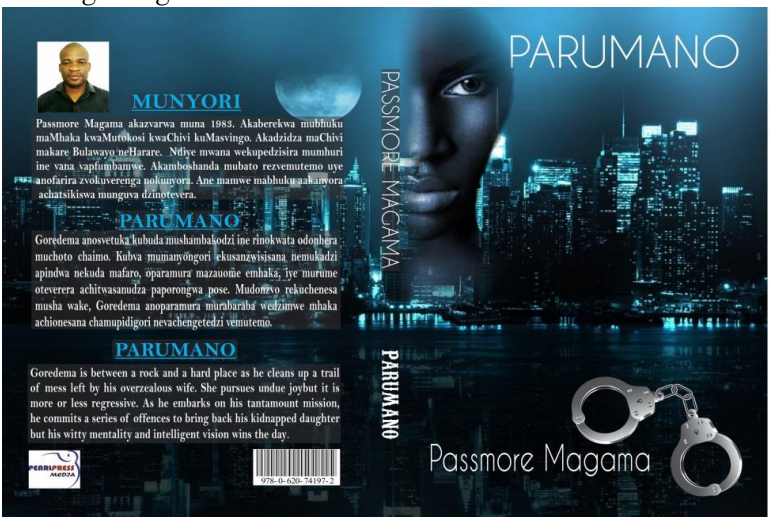
The covers I have put above were professionally done. Thanks to our designers who professionally designed the covers so that they catch the minds of the buyers.

Normally what most authors may be imagining about their cover may not best suit the title of the book, unless a good designer interprets the thoughts of the author well in a good design. A cover may not need to suit your story sometimes; but it may only need to match your TITLE only and NOT your story. An example of this is that cover of the book titled, "How to live with sufficient grace." The contents in the book have nothing to do with food as you see on the cover. But those images were placed because they suit the TITLE rather than the contents. Do you see how the title blends with the design? However, if you read the book you will see that the cover design INDERICTLY shows the contents of the book.

Of course, for our designers to do a cover for an author they first need to be told in brief about the contents of the book. After that they decide what design can best suit the book. Author's suggestions are also welcome, but the designer will

also suggest his own opinions. After a mutual agreement work begins.

Another thing about cover design an independent author must be aware of is the spine of the book. The spine is very important because that is what other people may see if your book is piled or stacked among others in a bookstore. The following image shows what I mean.



The spine is the centre of your cover where the title of your book and your name as the author are written vertically. Should your book be stacked among others in a bookstore, the spine is what the customers will see and they can easily identify your book without seeing the front cover.

The back cover of your book is also very important and should not be ignored. The back cover includes the information about

your book, author photo, ISBN Barcode, publisher's logo (that is if you have published through a publisher or you have used the services of a publishing consultants), and information about the author.

After the customer has been drawn to your book because of your catchy front cover he/she will turn to the back of your book in order to know what exactly the book is all about.

Don't let the customer be turned off when he/she sees how unprofessional your book looks. The things that can turn off or turn on a customer are:

- **The design of the back cover**
- **The book description**

  Make it a point to write a catchy book description for your book. Don't write a one sentence description. Most self-publishing authors tend to write just a few sentences describing their books. But it must not be so. Take your time describing your book but make sure you use the right words that can compel the customer to buy your book.

  Words to describe a novel may be: Action-packed, Adventurous, Awe-inspiring, Breath-taking, Captivating, Dazzling, Dynamic, Easy-to-read, Educational, Emotional, Enchanting, Elusive, Fascinating, Glamorous, Heart-wrenching,

Hilarious, Inspirational, Historical, Invigorating, Magnificent, Mind-numbing, Romantic, Tear-jerking, Spine Tingling, Thought-provoking, Tragic, Unique, and many more.

However, if you are not skilled in describing a book you can have someone who has read your book, especially your editor, describe the book for you. This is one of the things editors are skilled at.

- **Author photo**

Another thing that makes the back cover of the books of most self-publishing authors look unprofessional is the author photo that is placed on the back. DON'T ever use a photo that you take using your phone. The best thing you can do is to go to a photo studio and have an expert take you a photo.

A poor quality photo may turn off a potential buyer.

- **ISBN Barcode**

An ISBN barcode is another thing that makes your book look professional. The barcode on its own can draw the attention of the buyer. It makes your book look like a real book.

The following is an image of an ISBN barcode:



What does it cost me to have my book cover designed?

For a quote on cover designs call or WhatsApp: +263 775 101 750

It is difficult to give an exact price for cover design since we consider the following:

1. Cost of buying stock photos
2. Cost of illustration (If an author may require us to illustrate or have an artist draw animated illustrations of scenarios he/she wants on the cover)
3. Photo shoot (In cases where we may need to take photos of what is to be placed on the cover)

However, the cheapest way would be to let our designers use free licenced photos for commercial use

which may be available on the web. The limitation here is that we may not find the exact photos the author may require. Or the author can just provide photos (but these should be in high resolution)

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Typesetting/Interior page formatting

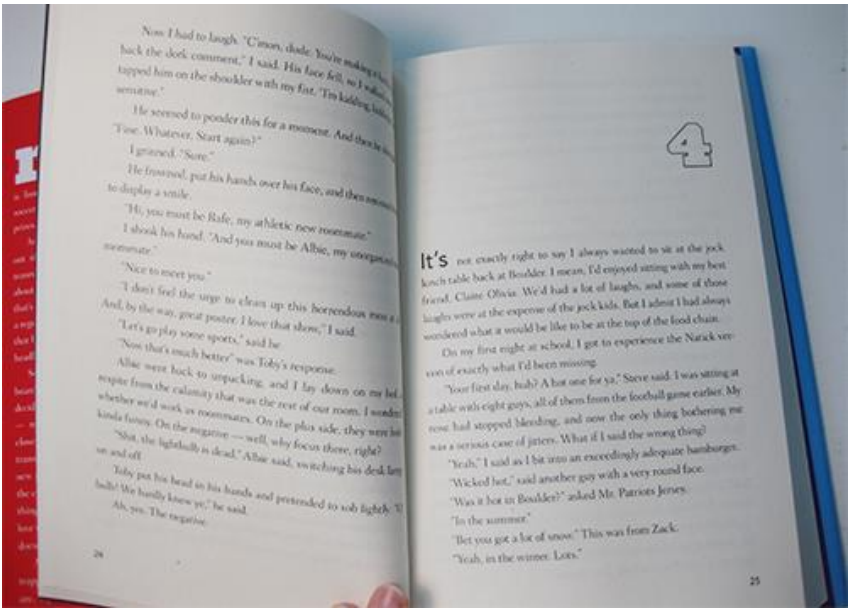
This involves setting the text in your book so that it looks like a real book and not like a mere document. Most self-publishing authors are not aware of this and that is why their books appears to be poorly done when you open them.

After you type your book using Microsoft word you will then need someone who is well learned in what is called typesetting or formatting to turn your document into a real novel type book.

This is a fact—your typed book remains a mere document until it goes through Typesetting by a professional. Don't ever make the mistake of printing your *document* thinking it is a book.

Formatting involves setting the margin, borders, page numbering, the gutter position, choosing the right fonts (there are certain type of fonts that should never be used for novels and related books), aligning the text, page headers, using a consistent font, choosing the right font sizes, the size of the book and many other things.

The following images are examples of books that have gone through professional typesetting.



Now I had to laugh. "C'mon, dude. You're making a
back the dork comment," I said. His face fell, so I
tapped him on the shoulder with my fist. "I'm kidding, bro
sensitive."

He seemed to ponder this for a moment. And then he
"Fine. Whatever. Start again?"

I grinned. "Sure."

He frowned, put his hands over his face, and then
to display a smile.

"Hi, you must be Rafe, my athletic new roommate."

I shook his hand. "And you must be Albie, my overgrown
roommate."

"Nice to meet you."

"I don't feel the urge to clean up this horrendous mess
And, by the way, great poster. I love that show," I said.

"Let's go play some sports," said he.

"Now that's much better" was Toby's response.

Albie went back to unpacking, and I lay down on my bed
respite from the calamity that was the rest of our room. I wonder
whether we'd work as roommates. On the plus side, they were ho
kinda funny. On the negative — well, why focus there, right?

"Shit, the lightbulb is dead," Albie said, switching his desk lam
on and off.

Toby put his head in his hands and pretended to sob lightly. "I
bulb! We hardly knew ye," he said.

Ah, yes. The negative.

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It's not exactly right to say I always wanted to sit at the jock
lunch table back at Boulder. I mean, I'd enjoyed sitting with my best
friend, Claire Olivia. We'd had a lot of laughs, and some of those
laughs were at the expense of the jock kids. But I admit I had always
wondered what it would be like to be at the top of the food chain.

On my first night at school, I got to experience the Natick ver-
sion of exactly what I'd been missing.

"Your first day, huh? A hot one for ya," Steve said. I was sitting at
a table with eight guys, all of them from the football game earlier. My
nose had stopped bleeding, and now the only thing bothering me
was a serious case of jitters. What if I said the wrong thing?

"Yeah," I said as I bit into an exceedingly adequate hamburger.

"Wicked hot," said another guy with a very round face.

"Was it hot in Boulder?" asked Mr. Patriots Jersey.

"In the summer."

"Bet you got a lot of snow." This was from Zack.

"Yeah, in the winter. Lots."

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ing for something light to say, I added, "I can show you my house if you'd like."

They all laughed, and I felt a little better. It was hard to be a display, but there was also something exhilarating about it.

"It's her first time in a mall," said Valerie.

"No way," said Carly. "Did you buy anything?"

"A dress and some makeup," I said, trying to sound casual.

"How was the party last night?" Valerie asked Carly.

"Fun," said Carly. "I'm sorry you couldn't come."

Valerie looked at me as though we were in on a secret. Then she turned back to Carly. "I couldn't come because I was out with Greg And Eliza and Josh."

Jill's eyes widened at the mention of Josh's name. "Josh, you heard right," said Valerie. "We got Josh out."

Jill turned to me. "Nice move." I wasn't sure what she meant, but it seemed related to what Valerie had just told me about Josh.

"I know, right?" said Valerie. Then she started lifting out her purchases for Jill and Carly to admire. As I watched them, my thoughts returned to Josh.

Apparently he had a story, and Valerie thought I was a part of it.

CHAPTER

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I still couldn't figure out what to write in my journal, so I began to list the things I'd done here that I couldn't do at home. Every day I had new items to add, like listening to music through the computer, setting the coffeemaker so the coffee would be brewed when I woke up in the morning, and maneuvering my own set of controls when I played Mario with the children.

Ben had seemed to enjoy teaching me how to play the video game, so I started searching for ways he could show me other things that he knew and I didn't. I thought it might help him get more comfortable about having me around. One day after camp, we leaned together over the kitchen table with the sports page open to the box scores. He pointed to one of the squares of text, numbered rows and columns. "See this row on the left? These are the players," he said. "And these boxes show how many at bats, hits, runs, and runs batted-in each player had."

I thought about what he had taught me about the game of baseball and tried to make sense out of the numbers on the page. I



sewentien

Lentevoetbaltyd gee vir John nog 'n rede om weg te wees van die huis af. Daarby is daar ook die wete dat hy en Abby binne drie kort maande 'n einde kan maak aan die oëverblindery en sal kan aangaan met die res van hul lewe. Wat dit ook al mag beteken. Daarvan is John nie seker nie, maar hy is meer as dankbaar vir die ure wanneer hy langs die skool se oefenveld kan staan. Sonder om te dink kan hy kommentaar en aanmoediging uitblaf terwyl die span speltegnieke oefen en voorberei vir 'n seisoen wat nog maande ver is.

Helder namiddagson brand op die veld neer en dit is buitengewoon warm vir hierdie tyd van die jaar. Geen wonder die span sukkel om te konsentreer nie. John kruis sy arms en gaan staan met sy voete skouerbreedte uitmekaar, sy knieë stewig reguit. Dis 'n houding waarmee sy spelers vertroud is; een wat altyd lyk of dit sy absolute gesag oordra.

Sy quarterback, 'n tweedejaar wat reken hy gaan Kade se posisie oorneem, val terug en soek naarstiglik na iemand om die bal te ontvang. Verder veld af struikel twee spelers oormekaar toe die bal hoog bo hul kop die lug inskiet.

'Begin weer,' blaf hy die bevel. 'Julle lyk soos 'n spul be-

ginners. Begin oor en doen dit reg, anders gaan ons die hele middag hiermee tydmors. Vat dit stadig. Onthou julle moet die taktiek leer.'

Net daarna verloop dit gladder en die bal beland maklik in die hande van die regte speler. 'Dis beter! Dis hoe dit gedoen word. Nou speel julle soos kampioene. Hou so aan!'

Vir byna twintig jaar het hy elke lente dieselfde goed uitgeskree. Teen hierdie tyd kan hy dit byna outomaties doen en 'n intensiewe oefening afrig terwyl sy gedagtes kilometers ver is.

Om presies te wees, ses kilometer ver. By die huis wat hy en Abby nog steeds deel, die plek waar trouplanne gedurig die middelpunt van elke gesprek is en waar die vrou met wie hy getroud is die kuns vervolmaak het om hom te vermy.

Gaan dit dan nou so eindig, Here? In 'n gemoesmoes van bedrywigheid en trouplanne en beloftes van nuwe liefde. Die hele gesin is net opgewonde oor Nicole en Matt se viering. Al die planne laat nie eens 'n halfuur oor vir hom en Abby om te gesels oor hoe hulle dit moet doen nie; hoe hulle die bande van twintig jaar gaan breek nie. Gaan alles wat hulle gehad het, alles wat hulle saam meegemaak het, net in die niet verdwyn?

Die liefde verdra absoluut alles, my seun. Die liefde vergaan nimmermeer.

John klem sy kake opmekaar. 'Regterkant toe, Parker,' skree hy. 'Die verdediging neem elke keer dieselfde posisies in. Voetbal is 'n spel van aanpassings.'

Dis nie 'n kwessie van liefde nie; dis 'n kwessie van losmaking. Die liefde ontbreek lank reeds in hul huwelik. Twintig jaar gelede, selfs tien, sou hierdie skeidingsproses ondraaglik gewees het. Wat hy en Abby nou gaan verloor, is egter 'n geriefshuwelik. Twee mense wat 'n manier uitgewerk het om saam te bestaan, rekeninge betyds te betaal en

If you can look closely on the images I have given, the first sentence of each of the paragraphs begins at a point that is some few TABS going to the right. This is one of the things that Microsoft word does not automatically do unless it has been programmed by a person who is skilled in formatting.

Layout can be done better in Adobe InDesign. However, we do have a basic typesetting template on our site (www.pearlpressmedia.co.zw/downloads) which one can

download and use for free. The only drawback is that this template is very limited, but for a start you can use it.

ISBN (International Standard Book Number)

By obtaining an ISBN number your book will have been registered as one of Zimbabwe's literature.

Every book that is published has got its own unique number. An ISBN number can be purchased from various ISBN agents like Bowker, isbn.com and many other agents. In Zimbabwe ISBNs are purchased at the National Archives of Zimbabwe at $2 (But you have to contact them first in case the price has changed).

As Pearl Press Media our ISBNs are purchased at the National Archives of Zimbabwe as well.

If we are to purchase an ISBN on your behalf you will pay us more than $2 since we will register your book in our name as your publisher. But if you are to purchase the ISBN on your own you will have to write your name as the publisher.

-4-

Editing

This involves correcting your grammatical errors, spellings, punctuation, and plot of the story, communication skills and the like. This is one of the most important things in the process of book publishing.

You as an individual may not know the right words to use when telling your story. Editors are people who are skilled in communication. They are the masters of a certain language.

Editors do not only correct your grammar but your communication skills as well. They know the psychology behind communication.

The following is what editing is:

1) Ensures your written message matches what you were trying to say

2. Helps bring structure and balance to your writing.

3. Checks your sentences and paragraphs to make sure one idea flows smoothly to the next.

As a writer, you know what you want to say. You may think your writing communicates this message effectively. However, it may be that your message is not getting across. Editing involves:

a. Copyediting for grammar, usage, spelling, punctuation

b. Stylistic editing (clarifying meaning, eliminating jargon, polishing language; line-by-line editing for smoothness and clarity while maintaining author's voice and style)

c. Developmental editing: critique

The Editor will edit, and then send manuscript to Author for approval; Author will either accept or reject changes and answer any of the Editor's queries, and then return the manuscript to the Editor, who will incorporate those changes or corrections into the manuscript and clean the copy of editorial markings.

Editing is one of the most important things in book publishing and should never be skipped. Give it time. There is no point trying to quickly get your book on the market if it is not properly edited. It is costly to have your book edited but you have to.

What does it cost for editing a book?

Price of editing depends with the editor. Some editors charge $1 per page, while some charge $0.50 per page. Others charge a fixed amount say $100 or even more.

However, one can talk with the editor and negotiate on the price.

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Printing

Once your book has gone through those four steps it will then be considered print ready. Printing is charged on its own and the cost of printing depends on the number of pages in your book, size, and the type of printing you may want in terms of quality (i.e. Type of binding; cover finish, for example, laminated, gloss, matte or UV varnished).

NB: If you want high quality printing be prepared to pay more.

You have to look for a company that prints quality books. I know that self-publishers try to avoid the high cost of printing by going to some individuals who do not have the right printing equipment and the result is that the quality of their books becomes compromised.

You may complain at the high cost of printing that big companies may charge, but I tell you that if you can have the patience to look around these companies you will find one that is cheap and produces a quality product.

It happened with me. My book had been printed in USA and I then wanted a local company that would produce the same

quality as the USA Company but all the companies I approached would ask unreasonably high prices. Most of the quotations I received from these local firms would range between $9- $11 per copy.

However, as I continued to roam around for several months I found one company that quoted me $4.38 to print the book and they delivered exactly the same quality that the USA Company had delivered. Have you noted something about my success in publishing?—I had patience.

Of course to most authors, $4.38 is very expensive but your book may cost less because my book was formatted at 6x9 inches American standard size and it is costly to print a book on that size.

When we do Typesetting at Pearl Press Media we format your book to size A5 which is generally the Zimbabwean standard size for books and this is less costly when printing.

As Pearl Press Media we also do printing for books. You can try us. We ensure you the best quality at cheap prices.

Regards,

Pearl Press Media